

METHODOLOGICAL GUIDE FOR STUDENTS (CASE 32)

Project: Implementing Data Loss Prevention (DLP) & Securing Confidential Data

1. Project Workflow & Milestones

To successfully complete this project, teams should follow these four logical stages:

- **Stage 1: Asset Classification.** Define what data needs protection (e.g., trade secrets, PII, financial plans, intellectual property).
- **Stage 2: Threat Modeling (Task 1).** Identify internal risks (malicious leaks, accidental exposures) and external risks (phishing, credential theft).
- **Stage 3: Technical DLP Design (Task 2).** Plan endpoints controls (USB, printers), network gateways (Email, Web, HTTPS), and data discovery.
- **Stage 4: Organizational Measures.** Establish legal frameworks like Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDA), internal security policies, and incident response team rules.

2. Threats Matrix Reference Table

Students can utilize the following structural template to categorize enterprise data threats:

Threat Vector	Channel / Vulnerability	DLP Protective Action
Internal Malicious	Mass USB download / Personal Email	Block USB copy, Flag keyword triggers
Internal Accidental	Wrong recipient in Outlook/Webmail	Prompt warning / Quarantine outgoing files
External Attacker	Compromised accounts / Phishing	Behavioral anomalies detection & MFA alerts

3. Flowchart Requirements (Task 2)

The required architectural flowchart must clearly visually distinguish and connect:

1. **Data Interception Points:** Endpoint agents, network perimeter sniffers, mail relays.
2. **Decision Nodes:** Content inspection rules (Regular expressions, Digital Fingerprints, Exact Data Matching).
3. **Enforcement Actions:** Allow, Block, Log, or Quarantine.
4. **Administrative Procedures:** Incident reporting to Security Officers, triggering corporate HR or legal escalation policies.